

HM Pepper Chicken

6 servings | Low Sodium | High Protein | Zero Added Sugars

INGREDIENTS

- 1.75 lbs boneless skinless chicken breast, fat trimmed
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1 tsp onion powder
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1/4 tsp MSG
- 1 Vidalia onion, sliced
- 1 large red bell pepper, sliced
- 3 jalapenos, sliced (seeds in for more heat, out for less)
- 2 Thai chilies, sliced
- 1 habanero, minced
- 7 medium cremini mushrooms, sliced

PREP NOTES

Heat Level: This recipe is hot. The combination of jalapenos, Thai chilies, and habanero creates significant heat. For a milder version, remove seeds from the jalapenos and skip the Thai chilies. For max heat, keep everything as is.

Chicken Prep: Trim any visible fat from the chicken breast before cooking. Cut into uniform pieces roughly 1.5-2 inches for even cooking. Pat dry with paper towels before seasoning - this helps the spice rub adhere and promotes better browning.

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1 - Season the Chicken

Combine cumin, onion powder, garlic powder, smoked paprika, black pepper, and MSG in a small bowl. Pat the chicken dry, then coat evenly with the spice mixture. Let it sit for at least 10 minutes at room temperature to allow the flavors to penetrate. For best results, season and refrigerate uncovered for 1-2 hours before cooking.

Step 2 - Prep the Vegetables

While the chicken marinates, slice the Vidalia onion, red bell pepper, jalapenos, and Thai chilies into thin strips. Mince the habanero finely - wash your hands thoroughly after handling. Slice the cremini mushrooms about 1/4 inch thick.

Step 3 - Sear the Chicken

Heat a large skillet or cast iron pan over medium-high heat. Add the olive oil and let it shimmer. Add the chicken pieces in a single layer - do not overcrowd. Sear for 4-5 minutes per side until golden brown and cooked through (internal temp 165F). Work in batches if needed. Transfer cooked chicken to a plate and cover loosely with foil.

Step 4 - Cook the Vegetables

In the same pan over medium-high heat, add the onion and bell pepper. Cook for 3-4 minutes, stirring occasionally, until they begin to soften and pick up some color. Add the jalapenos, Thai chilies, and habanero and cook another 2 minutes.

Step 5 - Add Mushrooms

Add the sliced cremini mushrooms to the pan. Cook for 3-4 minutes until they release their moisture and begin to brown. Do not stir too frequently - let them sit long enough to develop color on each side.

Step 6 - Combine

Return the chicken to the pan with the vegetables. Toss everything together over medium heat for 1-2 minutes to meld the flavors. Taste and adjust - if it needs brightness, a small splash of apple cider vinegar works well.

Step 7 - Rest and Serve

Remove from heat and let rest for 2-3 minutes before serving. This allows the juices to redistribute through the chicken. Serve over HM Quinoa, with HM Black Beans, or alongside HM Salsa and corn tortillas.

NUTRITION TABLE

Per serving (1 of 6) | Based on 2,000 calorie diet

Nutrient	Per Serving	Daily Value	%DV
Calories	187	—	9%
Total Fat	4.43g	78g	6%
Saturated Fat	0.35g	20g	2%
Sodium	151.83mg	2300mg	7%
Cholesterol	87.5mg	300mg	29%
Carbohydrates	8.35g	275g	3%
Total Sugars	4.52g	—	—
Added Sugars	0g	50g	0%
Dietary Fiber	1.8g	28g	6%
Protein	31.02g	50g	62%
Calcium	21.33mg	1300mg	2%
Iron	0.68mg	18mg	4%
Potassium	696.67mg	4700mg	15%

%DV based on 2,000 calorie diet.